

# Safe and Harassment-Free Research Work Environments (SAHF) Plan

## Overview

The organizers are committed to providing a professional, inclusive, respectful, and harassment-free environment for all workshop participants, regardless of race, ethnicity, nationality, gender identity, sexual orientation, disability status, religion, age, career stage, or institutional affiliation. The workshop will bring together researchers, industry practitioners, government representatives, and students to discuss challenges associated with the security and resilience of future non-terrestrial networks (NTNs). The organizers recognize that meaningful scientific collaboration and innovation depend on creating an environment in which all participants feel welcome, respected, supported, and empowered to contribute fully to discussions and workshop activities

## Code of Conduct

A comprehensive Code of Conduct will be developed and distributed to all participants prior to the workshop. Participants will be required to acknowledge the Code of Conduct during registration, and printed copies will be available at the venue. The Code of Conduct will emphasize professionalism, mutual respect, and a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, bullying, intimidation, and other inappropriate behavior.

All workshop participants, including organizers, speakers, panelists, attendees, students, volunteers, and support staff, will be expected to adhere to a professional code of conduct. Harassment, discrimination, intimidation, bullying, retaliation, or other inappropriate behavior will not be tolerated. Examples of unacceptable behavior include, but are not limited to:

- Harassing, intimidating, or discriminatory verbal or written comments;
- Personal attacks or disruptive behavior during presentations, discussions, or networking events;
- Unwelcome physical contact or sexual attention;
- Deliberate intimidation, stalking, or threatening behavior;
- Recording or photographing individuals without permission in restricted settings;
- Any conduct that interferes with another participant's ability to fully engage in workshop activities.

Participants who violate the code of conduct may be removed from the workshop at the discretion of the organizers.

## Communication and Reporting Procedures

Prior to the workshop, participants will receive information describing the workshop code of conduct, reporting procedures, and available support resources. Workshop participants may report concerns, incidents, or inappropriate behavior to any of the following:

- Workshop organizers;
- Designated points of contact identified in workshop materials;

- George Mason University police, security officers, and officials responsible for compliance and participant safety.

To avoid a single point of failure, multiple organizers will serve as reporting contacts. Participants may choose whichever contact they are most comfortable approaching. Reports may be made in person, by phone, or by email. The organizers will respond promptly to all reports, maintain confidentiality to the extent possible, and coordinate with appropriate university officials when necessary.

## **Training and Participant Awareness**

All organizers and session moderators will review the workshop code of conduct and incident response procedures prior to the event. At the beginning of the workshop, participants will be reminded of the workshop's commitment to maintaining a professional and inclusive environment and informed of the available reporting mechanisms.

## **Response to Incidents**

The organizers will promptly investigate reported incidents and take appropriate actions consistent with university policies and applicable laws. Potential responses may include:

- Informal resolution when appropriate;
- Formal warnings;
- Removal from specific workshop activities;
- Removal from the workshop;
- Referral to George Mason University officials or other appropriate authorities.

Participant safety and well-being will be prioritized throughout the response process.

## **Commitment to Broad Participation**

The workshop organizers are committed to fostering broad participation from academia, industry, government, and standards organizations. Special attention will be given to encouraging participation from students, early-career researchers, and participants from a broad range of institutions and technical disciplines. By creating a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment, the workshop seeks to maximize scientific exchange, community building, and the development of a shared research agenda for secure and resilient non-terrestrial networks.